

Kourosh Kouchakpour

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Profile: I am a CRM expert and have a confidently varied Administration, HR, Compliance, Payroll, Sales and Customer Services, and I.T. and Web Design background with over 15 years experience of working in various small and large business companies.

I am adaptable, proficient in customer relations systems, and enjoy taking part in sports and music performances, and have a bright, outgoing nature, and work harmoniously with people of all ages and backgrounds in a variety of workplace contexts. I am looking for an employment with perspective to develop my knowledge, skills and work

Skills and assets:

- Driving license, category B
- Excellent interpersonal, organisational and communication skills
- Ability to working under pressure
- Software e.g. T24, CRM, Excel, Office, Power Point
- Positive attitude towards life
- Excellent in accuracy and attention to detail
- Quantitative and Qualitative data analyst
- Portable Enhanced Disclosure (DBS)
- Excellent team player

Education:

- **2008 - BA** in Business Administration
- **2010 - MA** in Educational Administration
- **2012 - Pre-Master** in English Advanced and Proficiency levels
- **2012 - E.F.C.E.L.T.** Diploma in English
- **2013 - MSc** in Social Research Methods
- **2015 - Level 2 NVQ** Certificate in Spectator Safety
- **2019 – Ph.D.** in Widening Participation, Inclusion and Diversity

Experience:

Dec 2019 – Current, **Metro Bank – CSR (Customer Service Representative)**

Duties: customers' needs assessment; finding solutions for customers and advising them on the Bank services; opening accounts for customers and providing loan, overdraft, and credit card facilities; helping customers with Magic Money Machines and Safe Deposit boxes; participating in store events (including Kids Rock, Dogs Rule, Grand Openings, Metro Money Zone); coaching colleagues, and active contribution in the Bank's inclusion and diversity programs and events.

Apr 2019 – Current, **Open Society Foundations – Professional Business Development Consultant**

Duties: policy analysis; providing institutional development support to Open Society's partner organisations, working on fundraising, EU grant and funding application and proposal writing; supporting grantees on writing and finalising research bids submitted to international organisations such as PORTICUS, OSF, Council of Europe etc.; advising international NGO's on widening minority children's access to quality education, including enrolment of Roma children, and strengthening leadership capacity of Roma parents in Central Eastern Europe. As the OSF consultant, I assist their grantee and partner organisations to a) rebuild foundations to advance national and international advocacy strategies, and b) help them to enhance their efficiency and effectiveness respectively through human recourse overlap reduction and merging their capitals. I mentor them to establish a comprehensive organizational structure that would endure their sustainability and enable them to widen their scope of activities to become an 'attractive for collaboration hub' within the international community. I provide them with professional consultancy and mentoring at management, organisational, and capacity building levels.

Sep 2017 – Nov 2019, **Institute of Infrastructural Development – Account Manager**

- **Customer service, dealing with clients - retail and wholesale** (Duties: marketing, preparation of offers in word and excel and sending them to the potential/prospective customers, placing orders, complaint handling, full service of an internet outlet, customer service over the phone, contact with buyers, inductions and introducing new products, order processing, supplying storage facilities, sales analysis and making orders according to the product brand)
- **Bookkeeping and preparation of documents for the customers and the finance department** (Duties: country sales invoices, export sales invoices, country purchase invoices, import purchase invoices, logistics, stock audit)
- **Ordering of products from in and out of the country suppliers**

- **Sales and purchase analysis**
- **Management of a shop network** (Duties: organisation of recruitment meetings, store supplying, organisation of new outlet openings, contact with shopping centres' and building management representatives, collaboration with regional network managers)
- **Office administration** (Duties: market assessment and identifying cheaper suppliers, arrangement of management meetings, collaboration with partnership traders, organisation of warehouse functioning and keeping records of necessary documentations, transport organization, debt collection and collaboration with the recovery company (also legal affairs), contact with IT companies)
- **Collaboration with all partnership companies** (Duties: organisation of new product introducing, vehicle registration and all documentation connected with exploitation, full office and business handling of all partnership companies).

Jan 2019 – Dec 2019, Sprachcaffe Group – PMO, Risk Assessment and Compliance Advisor

Duties: Hotel Management; design and development of a) risk assessments and compliance portfolio and database in accordance to the British Council's terms and regulations, and b) course activities and excursions timetable and database, student logs and activity logs; designing customer service and student satisfaction evaluation, feedback and assessment forms; developing student attendance forms and database; developing budget plans and database for social activities and excursion costs; designing student and staff codes of conduct and practice database.

June 2016 – Sep 2017, Sussex University Asia Centre -- Communication and Outreach Officer

Duties: web design and development; planning, coordinating and delivering the Centre's communications activity; developing Centre's capacity to engage proactively with all types of media including the development of the Centre's media contacts in the areas relevant to the Centre's work, and preparing and issuing press releases and managing other media activities; developing and maintaining relationships with all stakeholders around the UK and internationally, and building partnerships with other organisations; managing and producing annual Impact Report which involves working closely with the Director and external design agency; managing the Centre's website content and social media channels including web publishing etc.; managing; conducting research and organising conferences and social and networking events; and representing the Centre externally as required.

May 2015 – Jun 2016, Interserve Healthcare Group -- PMO Support, Auditor

Duties: I.T. support; assisting with professional staff recruitment and human resource management; complaint handling; staff and task management using softwares such as People Planner, Microsoft Office, Outlook, Word and Excel to design templates and data entry management; processing time sheet information for the Nurse and Carers' teams, and filing; dealing with telephone enquiries and conducting performance review and quality assurance; compliance management, and conducting telephone surveys and writing assessment reports.

Sep 2013 – Apr 2015, Sussex University Student Union Societies -- Event Manager

Duties: organising social and cultural events and activities such as film screening and musical concerts, and workshops for International students to promote a culture of togetherness and collaboration and facilitate their social integration; assisting students with academic and non-academic support and signposting them to social support departments such as student support unit, student life centre; organising and leading student trips; organising and taking part in running various social clubs such language café, buddy-ups, arts and culture exhibitions, discos, international festivals, table tennis tournaments, bike rides, picnics, etc.

Sep 2011 – Sep 2013, UK, Brighton -- Community Organiser

Duties: organising social and cultural events for Iranians, Kurdish and other communities living in East Sussex area; case work support and assisting asylums throughout the asylum seeking process at various stages; conducting research to identify and address the social, cultural and educational issues and challenges of the asylum seekers, refugees and their families and children (e.g. the issues related to re-settlement, housing, job searching and work permission, access to education, and studying).

Sep 2010 – Jun 2011, Shiraz University -- Musical Director

Duties: organising Music festivals & Band co-ordination, Organising international concerts, Organising transport and accommodation for overseas note speakers and professional musicians as well as contacting and corresponding with embassies for visa affairs.

Sep 2009 – Sep 2010, Shiraz University -- Students Scientific Affairs Manager

Duties included: research support, teaching and course support, organising research seminars, workshops and trainings for research students and early career researchers, contribution to research dissemination through production of newsletters and updating websites, planning for e-learning developments and designing and administrating virtual trainings, organising activities such as reading groups and work in progress seminars to promote the research environment for staff and PGR students.

Sep 2005 – Sep 2009, UNICEF partners -- Project Manager (PMO)

Duties: strategic planning, and collaborations with Red Cross and Red Crescent, Ministry of Education, and Ministry of Health and Well-being to support the Kurds and Iraqi asylum seekers; schooling and advocacy support plans; providing child protection support and Safeguarding monitoring to identify and address the vulnerable asylums' social, educational and welfare needs during their transitional process of re-settlement; and, organising social and sport clubs.

Duties: Swimming Coach, Lifeguard Duties, and Cash Handling at Admissions counter, customer service, complaint handling, and manual handling.

Hobbies and Interests:

My interests include writing for and editing student publications, involving in scientific seminars and conferences, research activities in higher education, playing various musical instruments, organising music festivals and performances, swimming and playing football and competitive table tennis. I also regularly do volunteer work, helping London and Brighton based asylum seekers, refugees, and children of migrants and other minority and vulnerable groups as well as other international students and families with translation, educational support, Music and English language tuition, and application/resume support. I have been actively volunteering with organisations and NGO's such as 'Refugee Radio', 'Kurdish Solidarity', 'Sussex Interpreting Services', 'BMECP', 'Bestfootmusic', 'The Voice of Santur' and 'Thousand 4 £1000', and have participated in and collaborated with organising various events and festivals such as 'Mate Café', 'Jollof Café', 'Migrant Lives Matter (2017)' and 'the Refugee Week'.

ACADEMIC AND PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES AND EMPLOYMENTS:

Papers & presentations:

1. *"Widening Students' Participation in Learning in Higher Education: A Case Study of Civil Engineering BSc Programme in an Iranian University in Kurdistan"*. 3rd International Kurdish Studies Conference, Middlesex University, June 2019.
2. *"An Analysis of the Civil Engineering BSc Students' Experiences of Participation in Learning in Higher Education in Iran"*. Research Student Conference, Sunderlnd, June 2018.
3. *"Students' Experiences of Participation in Learning in Higher Education in Iran: A Case Study of the Civil Engineering BSc Programme in an Iranian University"*. BERA Annual Conference, Sussex, September 2017.
4. *"Shifting Pattern(s) of Student Mobility in West Asia: An Analysis of the University Students' Challenges and Opportunities for Participation in International Contexts"*. West Asia Workshop, Sussex, May 2017.
5. *"Students' Gendered Experiences of Participation in Learning in Higher Education in Iran"*. Research Cafe, Centre for International Education (CIE), 2nd March 2017.
6. *"Students' Experiences of Participation in Learning: a Case Study of the BSc programme in Civil Engineering in an Iranian University"*. Research in Progress, CHEER, Sussex University, November 2016.
7. *"Higher Education of 21st Century, Accredited Clients and Unattended Talents? An Analysis of Students' Experiences of Participation in Learning in HE in Iran"*. Umea conference, Sussex University, March 2016.
8. *"An analysis of students' learning experiences of BSc programmes in Iran: Case study of Civil Engineering at Kermanshah Razi University"*. BAICE 2014 Conference, University of Bath, September 2014.
9. *"An analysis of the Barriers and Opportunities of Iranian Women in Relation to Their Access to Education in three distinct post-revolutionary Periods"*. NGender Conference, University of Sussex, 13 May 2014.
10. *"An analysis of students' learning experiences of BSc programmes in Iran: Case study of Civil Engineering at Kermanshah Razi University"*. Umea conference, University of Sussex, January 2014.
11. *"An Investigation into the Internal Effectiveness Evaluation of the ICT Undergraduate Curriculum from the viewpoint of Malek-Ashtar University Students"*. BSA Annual Conference 2013, London.
12. *"An analysis of international students' experiences of MA programmes in the UK: Case study of international education and development MA programmes at the University of Sussex and the London Institute of Education"*. Doctoral Student Research Conference, University of Sussex, July 2013.
13. *"In what ways is social research influenced by ontological and epistemological assumptions?"*. Doctoral Student Research Conference, University of Sussex, July 2013.
14. *"Assessment of Faculty Competences in Teaching Thinking Skills from viewpoint of Shiraz and Medical Universities Students"*. The 8th Asia Pasific Medical Education Conference, Singapore 2011.

Reviewer:

I have been a member of the reviewing committee that screened paper abstracts and selected presentations for: 1) Doctoral Student Research Conference, University of Sussex, 2) New Racisms 2014 Conference, University of Sussex.

Professional Training and Courses:

1. *Professional Banker Certificate*, Metro Bank, December 2021, UK.
2. *T102: Safeguarding*, Pet-xi, March 2019, UK.
3. *Third NAIRS (The Network of Academic Institutions in Romani Studies) Summer School for PhD students*, Professional Development Course (7 credits), Summer (25-28 September) 2018, Stokholm, Sweden.
4. *Safeguarding Awareness*, Sussex Interpreting Services. Summer 2017, UK.

5. *First NAIRS (The Network of Academic Institutions in Romani Studies) Summer School for PhD students*, Professional Development Course (7 credits), Summer (22-25 August) 2016, Bratislava (Senec), Slovakia.
6. *Performing Romani Identities: Strategies and Critique*, Professional Development Course, Summer 2016, Central European University.
7. *Equality, Diversity and Inclusion, and Culture Awareness*, University of Sussex, 2016.
8. *Mental Health Issue and Well-being*, University of Sussex, 2014 and 2015.
9. *Drug, alcohol, and Substance Abuse Awareness*, University of Sussex, 2014 and 2015.
10. *Student Safeguarding*, University of Sussex, 2014 and 2015.
11. *Health and Safety*, University of Sussex, 2014 and 2015.
12. *Confidentiality and impartiality*, University of Sussex, 2014.
13. *Bullying and Harassment, and Self Harm*, University of Sussex, 2014.
14. *Exploring Ethical Issues in Your Research*, training course for doctoral/early career researchers, Autumn 2014, University of Sussex.
15. *Elite interviewing*, Workshop, Summer 2014, University of Sussex.
16. *First Aid Training from the Red Cross*, Summer 2014, University of Sussex.
17. *Qualitative Comparative Analysis*, training course for doctoral/early career researchers, Summer 2014, Sussex Uni.
18. *Becoming an Effective Researcher*, Workshop, Spring 2014, University of Sussex.
19. *Covering your Research Costs*, Workshop, Spring 2014, University of Sussex.
20. *Discourse Analysis*, doctoral/early career researchers training course, Spring 2014, University of Sussex.
21. *EndNote: Introduction to Managing your Citations*, training course for doctoral/early career researchers, Spring 2014, University of Sussex.
22. *Disability, Discrimination and Social Justice*. 2013, University of Sussex.
23. *Evaluation of Policy & Professional Practice*, Workshop, Summer 2013, University of Sussex.
24. *Managing your research data*, Workshop, Summer 2013, University of Sussex.
25. *SAGE Journal's Writers' Workshop 2013*, Research Hive, University of Sussex.
26. *Social Inclusion in Education & Social Care*, Workshop, Summer 2013, University of Sussex.
27. *Creating a Research Blog*, Workshop, Spring 2013, University of Sussex.
28. *Ethnographic Methods*, training course for doctoral/early career researchers, Spring 2013, University of Sussex.
29. *Policy and Programme Evaluation Research*, training course for doctoral/early career researchers, Spring 2013, University of Sussex.
30. *Research Design and Ethics*, training course for doctoral/early career researchers, Spring 2013, Sussex Uni.
31. *Voice and Creativity in Research Writing*, training course for doctoral/early career researchers, Spring 2013, University of Sussex.
32. *Methods in Quantitative Data Collection and Analysis*, training course for doctoral/early career researchers, Autumn 2012, University of Sussex.
33. *Methods in Qualitative Data Collection and Analysis*, training course for doctoral/early career researchers, Autumn 2012, University of Sussex.
34. *Philosophy of Science and Social Scientific Research Practice*, training course for doctoral/early career researchers, Autumn 2012, University of Sussex.

Memberships of Organisations and Professional Groups:

1. Member, British Educational Research Association (BERA), 2016 - 2020.
2. Associate Fellow of the Higher Education Academy (AFHEA), 2016 - Current.
3. University of Sussex Asia Centre (USAC), 2015-2020.
4. Member, British Association for International and Comparative Education (BAICE), 2014 - 2020.
5. Executive committee member, BRISMES (British Society for Middle Eastern Studies) Annual Conference, University of Sussex, June 2014.
6. Executive committee member, Teacher Research Conference, Sussex University, June 2014.
7. Executive committee member, New Racisms: Forms of Un/Belonging in Britain Today Conference, University of Sussex, May 2014.
8. Executive committee member, Diversity, Democratisation and Difference: Theories and Methodologies Conference, University of Sussex, January 2014.
9. Chair, Student Experience Group, Sussex School of Education and Social Work, 2013-2014.
10. Executive committee member, University of Sussex Doctoral Studies Committee, 2013-2014.

11. Centre for Higher Education and Equity Research (CHEER), Sussex University, 2013-2018.
12. Centre for International Education (CIE), Sussex University, 2013-2018.
13. Executive committee member, Sussex Doctoral Student Annual Conference, 2012-2016.
14. Member, the British Sociological Association (BSA), since 2012.

Educational Qualifications and Awards:

- Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) degree in International Education and Development, University of Sunderland, UK, 2019.
- Associate Fellow of the Higher Education Academy (AFHEA), UK, 2016.
- Level 2 NVQ Certificate in Spectator Safety, The City and Guild of London Institute, UK, 2015.
- Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) Certificate, Portable Enhanced Disclosure DBS Check, UK, 2015.
- Researcher-Led Initiatives Award, Sussex University, 2014.
- Researcher-Led Initiatives Award, ESW Conference Committee, Sussex University, 2013.
- Master of Science (MSc) degree in Social Research Methods, University of Sussex, UK, 2013.
- Pre-Master and English courses in advance and Proficiency levels, Sussex University, UK, 2012.
- E.F.C.E.L.T. Certificate and Diploma (Equivalent to Cambridge Advanced C.A.E. Certificate), EF, UK, 2012.
- Excellence Award in Developing Cultural Activities, Shiraz University, Iran, 2011.
- Excellence Award in Media & Journalism, Shiraz University, Iran, 2011.
- Master of Arts (M.A.) degree in Educational Administration, Shiraz University, Iran, 2010.
- Excellence Award in Management of Students' Scientific Affairs, Shiraz University, Iran, 2010.
- BA (Hons) degree in Business Administration, Kermanshah Payam Noor University, Iran, 2008.
- Associate degree, Certificate of Sedan Repair (Gasoline Injection): Technical & Vocational Skill Training, Iran, 2007.
- Physics, Mathematics, Chemistry & Persian Literature (i.e. 4 A Levels at A Standard), Sharif College, Iran, 2003.
- Certificate of Preparatory Life Saving Exam, Red Crescent Iranian First Aid Course (Equivalent to St John Ambulance First Aid), Lifeguard Certificate, Life Saving Federation of Iran, 2001.

Previous Academic Experience

- 2015-2018: Research Associate, Sussex Asia Centre (USAC), Sussex University, UK.
- 2015-2018: Communication & Outreach Officer, Sussex Asia Centre (USAC), Sussex University, UK.
- 2014-2015: Researcher, 'Higher Education, Internationalisation, and Mobility' project, Centre for Higher Education and Equity Research (CHEER), Sussex University, UK.
- 2014-2018: Associate Tutor, International Summer School, University of Sussex.
- 2013-2018: Research Associate, Centre for International Education (CIE), University of Sussex.
- 2013-2018: Associate tutor, ESW, PhD Peers Support Group. Organising and leading group discussions for new PhD students.
- 2009: Associate tutor, Department of Educational Administration and Planning, Shiraz University, Iran. I taught I.T., Budgeting, Social research methods, English.
- 2003-2019: English language tutor (General & Academic English).
- 2003-2019: Curriculum planning and developing teaching and learning materials for young students and adults with special language and social needs (General & Academic).

References available upon request